

Order Passeriformes

Family Acanthisittidae

New Zealand wrens

Length 3¼–4 in (8–10 cm)

Species 4



Found only in New Zealand, this family includes the rifleman and rock wren. Both sexes of the rifleman and rock wren incubate eggs and feed the young. One species, the virtually flightless Stephens Island wren, was wiped out—ostensibly by a lighthouse keeper’s cat—in the late 1800s; another, the bush wren, was last seen in 1972. Other species are known from subfossils—all were probably weak flyers. Genetic and anatomical evidence suggest that this family represents an ancient lineage of birds that is the sister group to all other passerines.



**RIFLEMAN**  
Abundant and widespread, *Acanthisitta chloris* occurs on North and South Islands. It is 3¼ in (8 cm) long; unusually among passerines, the female is larger. She is also more streaked.

Family Pittidae

Pittas

Length 6–11 in (15–28 cm)

Species 42



Stumpy-looking birds with an acute sense of smell, pittas live on the forest floor in Asia, Australia, and Africa, and feed on insects, spiders, snails, and other invertebrates. They are secretive birds and seldom seen, often blending in with the forest floor despite their highly colorful plumage. The female lays 2–7 eggs and both sexes raise the young.



**AFRICAN PITTA**  
*Pitta angolensis*, one of two African species, is a migrant found in thick, evergreen forest. This usually silent bird is 8 in (20 cm) long.

Family Eurylaimidae

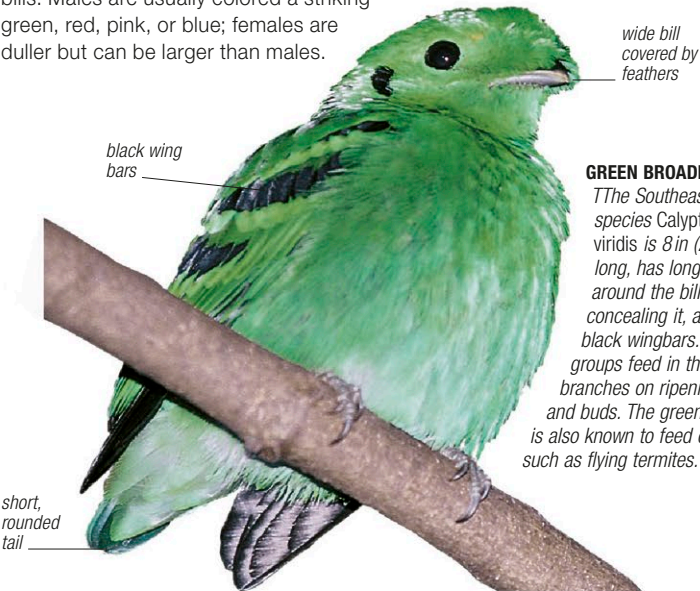
Broadbills

Length 5–11 in (13–28 cm)

Species 20



Broadbills are found across the humid tropics, from West Africa to the Philippines, in habitats including scrub and forest-edge thickets, mangrove swamps, inland forest, and mountain moss-forest. These plump birds have large heads and wide, flattened, hooked bills. Males are usually colored a striking green, red, pink, or blue; females are duller but can be larger than males.



**GREEN BROADBILL**  
The Southeast Asian species *Calyptomena viridis* is 8 in (20 cm) long, has long feathers around the bill, nearly concealing it, and 3 black wing bars. Small groups feed in the lower branches on ripening fruit and buds. The green broadbill is also known to feed on insects such as flying termites.

Family Furnariidae

Ovenbirds

Length 6–10 in (15–25 cm)

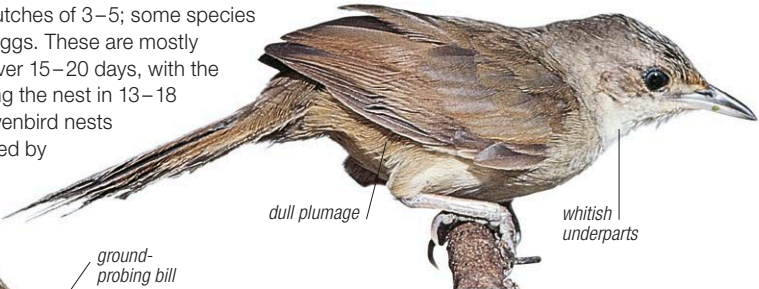
Species 314



A large group with many subfamilies, ovenbirds are mostly small brown birds with paler underparts, found in Central and South America. They live in a wide range of habitats, and may be foliage-gleaners, living in the canopy, or leaf-scrappers, which flick leaves in the air and skulk in the densest undergrowth. Many species, such as the true

ovenbirds, or horneros, prefer open country, while the cinclodes live along water courses; a few species inhabit marshes. A number of species, such as the Patagonian earthcreeper and brown cachalote, tend to run rather than fly. Ovenbirds are mostly insect-eaters, but some also feed on seeds. Their nesting habits vary widely: while the true ovenbirds build substantial, domed mud-ovens on tree branches, many species nest in natural holes, animal tunnels, or holes they dig themselves. The white-throated cachalote builds a huge stick nest that lasts for many years after the birds have used them. Almost all ovenbirds lay white eggs,

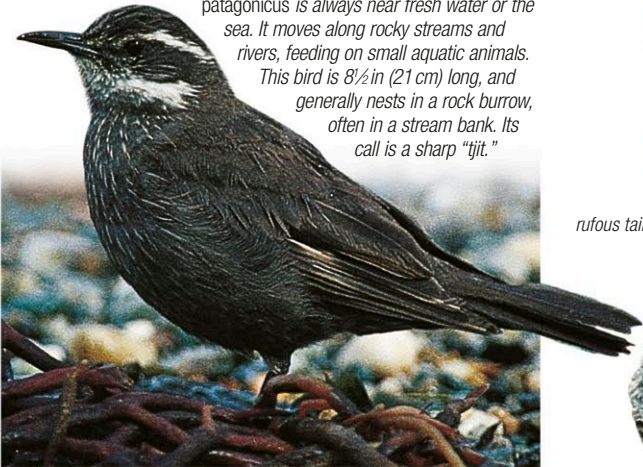
usually in clutches of 3–5; some species lay up to 9 eggs. These are mostly incubated over 15–20 days, with the young leaving the nest in 13–18 days. Old ovenbird nests are often used by other birds.



**RUFIOUS HORNERO**  
Argentina’s national bird, *Furnarius rufus*, has a misleading common name as it is the least rufous of horneros. Measuring 7–8 in (18–20 cm) in length, it clammers about on the ground or on branches. Its mud-oven nest, which it uses only once, adorns the top of fence posts and telephone poles, lasting for years.

**RUFIOUS-FRONTED THORNBIRD**  
Occurring in widely separated areas of semiarid habitat, *Phacellodomus rufifrons* is 6½ in (16 cm) long. It builds a large, hanging stick nest, which has several chambers and is often used by other birds. This South American bird spends much of its time in trees, in pairs or groups.

**DARK-BELLIED CINCLODES**  
Found in southwest South America, *Cinclodes patagonicus* is always near fresh water or the sea. It moves along rocky streams and rivers, feeding on small aquatic animals. This bird is 8½ in (21 cm) long, and generally nests in a rock burrow, often in a stream bank. Its call is a sharp “tjit.”



**BUFF-FRONTED FOLIAGE-GLEANER**  
*Philydor rufum*, 7½ in (19 cm) long, is locally common in humid mountain forests from Costa Rica to Argentina. It searches the canopy for insect prey, hanging upside down athletically.

